

The Falcon, from the cover to *Ultimate Nightmare (2004) #4,* by Steve Epting with colors by Frank D'Armata.

one that was even worse: the tragedy of him becoming something they'd both despise, which is an enemy of your own country."

Steve Epting had drawn *Captain America* hundreds of times as the artist on a popular three-year run of *Avengers* a decade earlier, but now his job was to create a modern version of a boy-hero from the 1940s.

"We went into the design of Winter Soldier with some specific requirements." Epting says. "The first was the metal arm that, as part of Ed's storyline, would replace the one Bucky lost during his last mission in World War II, and the second was the domino mask. We wanted some visual links to his Bucky costume, and the domino mask was the most obvious."

Epting added rows of snaps to recall Bucky's original double-breasted shirt and a red star to tie him to the Russians, who had fished the frozen hero out of the sea before indoctrinating and training the amnesiac Bucky as an assassin. He'd been kept in cryogenic stasis between missions and had aged only a few years during the intervening decades, making it difficult to update the character in a way that Steve Rogers would not recognize his former partner. Epting initially tried giving Winter Soldier a haircut similar to Bucky's.

"Ed, Tom Brevoort, Editor in Chief Joe Quesada, and I all agreed early on that the character did not look tough enough at that point. My recollection is that Joe suggested the longer hair—which did make him look more formidable, if not a bit sinister, and along with the mask helped obscure his face enough so that Captain America could not be sure it was really Bucky until he got face-to-face with him."

Both in the comics and on-screen, Captain America